

# AI in the Real World

Data, Power, & Society - Day 12

CMSE 492 (aka CMSE 101) • Fall 2026

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# From Frameworks to Your Own Case

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For four weeks we built DTPA one piece at a time: **Data** (Week 1), **Tools** (Week 2), **Practices** (Week 3), **Actions** (Week 4).

Starting today, you use all four at once, and **you find the case**.

- Weeks 1–4 asked: *where have we been?* — foundations and mechanics.
- Weeks 5–10 ask: *where are we now?* — real deployments, domain by domain.
- Three rounds, two weeks each. Today starts **Full Case I**.

# Full Case I: Choose a Domain

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Your group picks one broad domain, then narrows to **one specific, documented case** inside it.



- Healthcare



- Art & Creative Industries



- Education



- Athletics & Sports



- Politics & Government

**Domain is not a case.** *"AI in healthcare" is not a case; a specific hospital's use of a named documentation tool is.*

Your case needs: a **named tool**, a **named organization**, and a **documented deployment** (something that happened, with a date, from a citable source).

# How the Next Two Weeks Work

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Two things happen in parallel:

| Week | Individually                                                                                 | As a group                                                       |
|------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 5    | Review <b>one</b> domain above; summarize; write preliminary DTPA questions (→ Forum Post)   | Pick a domain, narrow to a case, find sources<br>→ <b>Update</b> |
| 6    | Review a <b>different</b> domain; summarize; write preliminary DTPA questions (→ Forum Post) | Complete the full DTPA analysis → <b>Full Case</b>               |

- The domain you review individually does **not** have to be your group's domain — reading outside it is the point.
- **Week 5 Update:** due Sun, Oct 4
- **Week 6 Full Case:** due Sun, Oct 11

# Your Case Study Document

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Same template family as your weekly Case Studies, split into two parts:

- **Part A (Week 5 Update)** — a checkpoint, not a draft. Sections 0–8 walk you through: your case statement, how you got there, sources so far, DTPA readiness, your thinnest part, disagreements, and your plan for Week 6.
- **Part B (Full Case)** — the complete DTPA analysis and Four Pillars reflection, same standard as your weekly Case Studies, plus **Similar Cases** and a group reflection.

**Use Section 0** to dump links, notes, and half-finished thoughts as you go — nothing there is graded, but nothing gets lost either.



Posted on D2L and linked from the [Week 5/6 schedule page](#).

# The Trap to Avoid

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**Do not stop at the first case you find, and do not default to the domains materials we posted.**

Those readings are the most visible stories in each domain — that's exactly why they're a place to **start**, not a place to **finish**.

- Follow one source to another.
- The best cases so far have come from groups chasing something nobody handed them.



- [AI Incident Database](#) · [AI Hallucination Cases Database](#) · [404 Media](#)

# Two New Opportunities This Semester

# New: The Honors Option

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An independent research option on the **energy, water, and political costs of AI computing**.

- **Eligibility:** 3.0+ in CMSE 101 — this builds on the course, it doesn't replace it.
- **Individual** project.
- Framed by **critical pragmatism**: name what's exploitative or oversold about a system, *and* end with something usable — a policy recommendation, a design constraint, practical guidance someone could reasonably argue against.

Every topic must address two required lenses:

1. **Hype vs. evidence** — hold an industry/marketing claim up against independent evidence.
2. **Labor and exploitation** — name who makes the system possible, and who's exposed to its harms.

# Honors Option — Topics & Logistics

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Choose **at least one**: AI policy & power · energy/water use case studies · open vs. closed systems · energy sources · edge computing · tokens as an efficiency metric · labor behind the systems.

**Format (your choice)**: ~3,000-word essay · 10-minute video + slides · scientific poster — must include a table of energy/cost calculations and your proposal.

## Milestones:

- Detailed plan (topic, format, schedule, 2–3 sources) — accepted before you file honors-college paperwork
- Mid-project prototype or outline — due mid-November
- Final product — due **Dec 21**

# New: Lead a Class (Optional)

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Starting **Week 11**, groups can opt to lead **half of a Monday or Wednesday class**, walking the room through one of your group's three Full Cases (I, II, or III) using DTPA.

- A **deeper engagement** option, not a requirement.
- Each student may do this **once**.
- What's expected: present your strongest evidence for one or two DTPA components, share any disagreements your group had, pose a discussion question — then write that day's **Exit Ticket**.
- Unclaimed half-classes (and all of Friday) stay **Case Design work time**.

# Sign Up to Lead

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Slots are one group per half-class, first-come first-served — email me to claim one.

| Date   | Day | Slot |
|--------|-----|------|
| Nov 9  | Mon | Open |
| Nov 11 | Wed | Open |
| Nov 16 | Mon | Open |
| Nov 18 | Wed | Open |
| Nov 23 | Mon | Open |
| Nov 30 | Mon | Open |
| Dec 2  | Wed | Open |

- Send your session plan **3 days before your slot** for feedback.
- After leading, a short individual reflection (~150 words) **replaces that week's case analysis.**

# Today: Get Started

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You have the rest of class to begin. By the time you leave today, your group should have:

-  Confirmed your Full Case I group (if not already set)
-  At least a short list of candidate domains you're willing to spend two weeks in
-  Started **Section 0** — save every link and idea as you find it

You have all week. The goal today is momentum, not a finished case.

# Reminders

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## Exit Tickets, D2L, and the Course Website

- Complete today's Exit Ticket by 11:59pm (on D2L)
- **Week 5 Update** (Full Case I, Part A): due Sun, Oct 4
- Individual Effort & Metacognitive Report: due Sun, Oct 4
- Review one Week 5/6 domain (see earlier slides) → Forum Post due Sun, Oct 4
- **Required this week:** select your **Case Design** groups (more on Case Design soon; can be same as Case Study groups)